What if the bubble just keeps getting bigger? Do we have picture spreads about the boys' first schools, first girlfriends, first everything else to look forward to? We've talked about that, and laughed about it together as well. But it's a serious question: how will it be for Brooklyn and Romeo if they're going to find themselves having to grow up in the public eye whether they like it or not? I think it's really important that, in the whirl of our lives together, we give our children the same solid base our parents gave Victoria and me. I know that, above everything, I owe my boys the same love and support and guidance I had at home, from my parents, my grandparents and the rest of our family.

In some ways, that's the easy bit: loving Brooklyn and Romeo, giving them the time and attention they need. It's a parent's instinct, after all. The more difficult thing is helping them through the extraordinary stuff that comes with life in Bubble Beckham; more difficult because Victoria and I are only finding out about that stuff as we go along ourselves. For a start, neither of us grew up with personal security being as much a part of everyday life as breakfast and dinner, which it is now. I don't mean the guys in blazers who hold back the crowds at airports. I'm really grateful they're there but, once we're through a terminal or wherever, those lads are gone: like us, they're on to the next job. I'm talking about the people who we trust to look after us and the boys, everywhere but inside our own four walls, 24/7.

It's been a strange road to where we are now with the whole issue of security. Soon after Victoria and I started going out together, I received a letter at my house in Worsley that contained two bullets in it and a scrawled note saying there'd be one for each of us. I can still remember standing by my pool table and the sound of the cartridges dropping out of the envelope and onto the table in front of me. That wasn't the only death threat we've had down the years, but it's the one that still makes my stomach turn over. When I came back to England after France 98, I felt threatened—really threatened—in ways I'd no real idea how to deal with. It would never have occurred to me, back then, to employ a bodyguard. I relied, like anyone else would, on the police and my mates. There were a couple of incidents at home—crashing garbage bins, strangers outside—when I got very scared indeed. I phoned 999 and then Giggsy. The police were always great and so was my neighbor: Ryan would be round in a flash, standing there just about awake in his tracksuit bottoms, baseball bat in hand, and ready to look after a mate.

The incidents that really changed how I thought about all this, though, were the kidnap threats. My children didn't choose their mum and dad so what's always upset me more than anything is when they get involved in